

**MAUSER MODEL 1871****MAUSER C.96**

- 1871** The Model 1871 is the first rifle manufactured by Paul and his brother, Wilhelm Mauser.
- 1874** The Mausers purchase the Württemberg Royal Armory and begin to make 100,000 Model 1871 rifles for Württemberg's army.
- 1878** Mauser develops the Zig-Zag, the first German military revolver to employ modern brass cartridges.

- 1896** The distinctive grip of the C.96 semiautomatic pistol leads to its nickname, "Broom handle."
- 1898** The Model 1898, purchased by the German Army, becomes the most successful Mauser rifle.
- 1914** Paul Mauser dies, but the company continues to prosper, supplying weapons in large numbers during World War I.

- 1918** The Mauser 1918 T-Gewehr is the world's first antitank rifle.
- 1935** The K98k is adopted by German armed forces.
- 1948** The Mauser factory is dismantled after World War II, and engineers salvage some of the equipment for the company that will become known as Heckler and Koch.

► YOUNG WINSTON

The actor Simon Ward, playing Winston Churchill in the 1972 film *Young Winston*, carries a Mauser C.96 pistol. Winston Churchill used this gun in the Sudan and during the Boer War, and it became his favorite weapon.

THE PISTOLS OF MAUSER

When the first semiautomatic pistols (see p.166) were developed by German gunsmiths such as Hugo Borchardt in the 1880s and 1890s, Mauser also moved into this market. Mauser's first, the highly successful C.96 (see p.166), was a highly distinctive firearm with a box magazine in front of the trigger and a grip that looked like the handle of a broom. The gun also had a removable wooden shoulder stock that doubled as a carrying case or holster. Carried by Winston Churchill and Lawrence of Arabia, the C.96 became well-known, and Mauser manufactured more than a million of them. The C.96 also took the Mauser name to China, where large numbers of the weapon were manufactured. The name Mauser is almost synonymous with "pistol" in many countries in Asia.

WAR AND PEACE

After World War I, the Mauser company used its engineering and manufacturing skills to branch out into peacetime products, such as tools, sewing machines, and even cars. But when Germany began to rearm in the mid-1930s, the Mauser line of firearms continued with the KAR 98k (see p.157), a bolt-action rifle first produced in 1935 but descended from the Model 1898 (left). Like the older rifle, the KAR 98k took ammunition loaded in a stripper clip, but it had a down-turned bolt handle (in contrast to the straight bolt handle of the Model 1898), which made for faster operation. The KAR 98k was used widely by the German army in World War II, especially for providing covering fire for machine-gunners.

